



IgniteX CONCEPT BOOKLET

Module 3

Lesson 2: Generate Solution Ideas

Context:

Generating solution ideas is a crucial stage in the entrepreneurial journey, where insights gained from customer research and validated personas are used to brainstorm innovative solutions. This phase calls for creative thinking and teamwork to tackle identified challenges and meet customer needs effectively. The objective is to develop a range of potential solutions suitable for prototyping and testing, with the aim of refining them into a product or service that successfully meets market demands.

Program overview, and your **Venture Journey** over 14 weeks

1. Problem Identification	2. Customer Identification & Needs Validation	3. Solution Idea Generation
Week 1	Weeks 2-3	Week 4
■ Orientation ■ Develop Macro Industry-Problem view ■ Discover 'Real World' Problems ■ Analyze Problems	■ Identify customer segments ■ Outline 'jobs-to-be-done' ■ Develop Initial Customer Personas ■ Understand Customer Validation ■ Validate Customer-Problem fit ■ Refine Customer Personas & Problem	■ Understand Ideation techniques ■ Generate Solution Idea ■ Map Solution-Problem fitment
4. Opportunity & Competition Mapping	5. Prototype Development & MVP	6. Opportunity Feasibility Assessment & Sizing
Week 5	Week 6	Week 7
■ Identify & map Global competitors ■ Review Industry Trends ■ Size the Market	■ Understand Prototypes & MVP ■ Build a Prototype ■ Use Prototype for early Validation	■ Determine your Relative Market Position ■ Estimate Opportunity Size and its Scope
7. Business Modelling	8. Marketing & Sales Strategy	9. Financial Management for Profitability
Week 8	Week 9	Week 11
■ Understand Revenue Model ■ Understand Lean Canvas ■ Build the LC for your Startup	■ Understand Marketing & Sales ■ Understand & Define Go-To-Market (GTM) approach ■ Understand Sales Process	■ Understand Startup Costs ■ Understand Profitability ■ Getting Started with Financial Planning ■ Understand & Explore Bootstrapping options
10. Team & Talent Requirement	11. Orientation for Scale	12. Venture Idea Feasibility Presentation
Week 12	Week 13	Week 14
■ Building a Founding team (A Team) ■ Founding team members (Co-Founders & Mentors) ■ Defining your Team Requirements	■ Thinking Beyond the Prototype - Scale Opportunity & Orientation ■ Getting Story Telling Right ■ Pitch preparation	■ Practice Pitch ■ Final Pitches

Concepts covered in this lesson:

Understanding Solution ideas

- The importance of generating solution ideas.
- Developing early solution ideas
- Using the right approach.

Shortlisting ideas

- Prepare a selection criteria
- Review solutions gathered.
- Identify and shortlist your solution idea.

Ideation Techniques

- Learn how to use creative and collaborative techniques to ideate.
- Understand idea components.
- Gather many solutions

After completing this lesson, you will be able to:

1. Approach problem-solving using creative techniques like SCAMPER, Brainstorming etc.
2. Leverage diverse perspectives to generate more ideas, keeping customer expectations, JTBD, and personas in mind.
3. Increase the ability to develop impactful and meaningful solutions with informed decision-making.

Steps for you to take:

1. Identify multiple techniques to develop solution ideas.
2. Map solutions to identified problems, demonstrating operational processes to visualize their effectiveness in action
3. Create criteria to select the right idea
4. Shortlist solution ideas.

Understanding Early Solution Ideas

Generating solution ideas is essential for addressing real needs, fostering innovation, mitigating risk, enhancing collaboration, driving competitive advantage, and supporting iterative improvement. This process is fundamental to successful problem-solving and sustainable growth in any organization. Early solution ideas:

Early solution ideas are like the seeds of your big solution tree. They're initial concepts or potential approaches to solving a problem. At this stage, they're not fully-fledged solutions yet. Instead, they're your first creative sparks that need nurturing, testing, and refining.

Top reasons to develop early solution ideas:

1. **Exploring possibilities:** They open doors to various solutions. The more ideas you have, the more options you'll explore to solve your problem.
2. **Avoiding Tunnel Vision:** They stop you from getting stuck on one solution. Having multiple ideas prevents you from locking into something that might not be the best fit.
3. **Learning and improving:** They set the stage for learning and improvement. Early ideas help you test, gather feedback, and make your final solution even better.
4. **Unleashing creativity:** They're your playground for creativity. Embrace wild and unconventional thoughts; they might just lead to groundbreaking solutions!

Developing Early solutions:

1. **Reacquaint with the problem:** Understanding the problem deeply is your compass for finding the right solution.

E.g Imagine you've identified a problem where people in your community struggle to access healthy food options. Revisit the interviews you conducted (mock or real); recall the stories and challenges shared by individuals regarding their food choices and

accessibility. Understanding these real-life situations deeply will guide your solution ideas.

2. Generate ideas: Frameworks and variations of Brainstorming can be used to generate innovative solution ideas. Gather diverse perspectives.

3. Quantity over Quality: Don't worry about perfection. Quantity often leads to quality in ideation. The more ideas you have, the better chance of finding a gem.

Set a target for the number of solutions you can come up with. Think big, think small, think weird! You might surprise yourself with idea number 19 or 20 – sometimes the best ones hide among the multitude.

4. Customers are Key: Ensure your ideas address customer needs and challenges directly.

If your interviews revealed that time and affordability were major concerns, consider solutions that cater to these needs. For example, if your users are interested in quick meal recipes, you may think of developing a mobile app where community members share quick, affordable, and nutritious recipes tailored to busy schedules.

Ideation Techniques:

- **SCAMPER:** This is a technique used to generate creative ideas by prompting different ways to modify or innovate existing products or

processes. It is to Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to other uses, Eliminate, or Reverse elements of their product design.

- **Brainwriting:** It is a variation of brainstorming where participants silently generate ideas in writing before sharing and discussing them as a group.
- **Round-Robin Brainstorming:** It is a structured brainstorming technique where each participant takes turns contributing ideas without interruption.
- **Cross-Pollination:** It is the exchange or combination of ideas, concepts, or strategies from different domains or industries to spark innovation

Shortlisting Ideas

Shortlisting ideas is a crucial step in the innovation process where the most promising and feasible concepts are selected from a larger pool of generated ideas. This involves evaluating each idea based on criteria such as potential impact, feasibility, alignment with customer needs, and resource availability.

What to include in the selection criteria

1. Do you have the technology to build it?
2. How much time will solution development take?
3. Do you have the team to develop it?
4. Can the solution scale?

5. How unique will the solution be?

What shortlisting ideas does:

- Reduces root causes
- Takes away any negative impact
- Helps achieve customers' JTBD by meeting their expectations and goals
- Meets customer expectations- goals

Finally make sure the solution:

- **Is distinctive:** Ensure the solution stands out by offering unique features or innovative approaches that differentiate it from existing alternatives.
- **Works well:** The solution should be reliable, efficient, and user-friendly, delivering a seamless and effective experience.
- **Creates benefits users will enjoy:** Design the solution to provide tangible advantages

Call-To-Action

Complete Venture Activity 3.2 – 3.4 - Select 'The' Solution Idea, Solution Design and User Experience

Develop your solution idea.

- 1. Use the brainstorming technique to generate solution ideas**
- 2. Evaluate the solutions generated based on the customer persona, JTBD, and expectations. Use clear criteria.**
- 3. Shortlist the solution idea to solve the problem.**

The solution idea can be crafted out of combining one or more ideas to make it highly effective and impactful.